

There is no joy in living a life where you deprive yourself of every small joy just to serve future you.

Future you needs to be taken care of, but we can take care of them while also allowing ourselves to enjoy the moment and live in the present. Investors in training understand that when it comes to their money habits, it's all about preservation over deprivation.

So how do you do it? Once you have an idea of how much you make and what you spend on a weekly and monthly basis, it's time to examine if this aligns with your value-based spending. Note down how much you spend on your needs, as well as your wants, in alignment with your goals.

If at this point you realise your values and spending aren't in alignment, it's time to sit down and allocate where you want to spend your money so things do start to align. Some people like to use images of things like buckets or hats. Some people like percentages. I just like to use numbers. It does the job. See [table 3.1](#). Take out a pen and jot down roughly how much you make a month and how you'd like to split that across your wants and needs. It'll take you four minutes at most, I promise.